



RICHARD RICE

AI STRATEGY & TRANSFORMATION
LEADER

CONTACT

Greenville, South Carolina

505-249-0446

rich@richardrice.me

linkedin.com/in/richardriceii

CERTIFICATIONS

CPMAI™: Certified Professional in
Managing AI — PMI

CAIC™: Certified AI Consultant & Trainer
CAITL™: Certified AI Transformational
Leader — USAII®

PL-900: Power Platform Fundamentals —
Microsoft

Generative AI Automation Specialist —
Databricks

Applied Generative AI for Digital
Transformation — MIT Professional
Education

Change Management for Generative AI |
Generative AI Leadership & Strategy
Specialization — Vanderbilt University

EDUCATION

Executive Scholar — AI Strategies for
Business Transformation: Generative and
Agentic Intelligence, Northwestern
University

B.A. Marketing Communications, Summa
Cum Laude, 3.94 GPA, Phi Beta Kappa
Honor Society — University of New
Mexico



PROFILE

Author. Practitioner. Builder. Led AI transformation across **150+ organizations**, taking each from readiness to enterprise-scale adoption and upskilling **500+ leaders** along the way. A hands-on operator for executive leadership who builds the agents and automations, not just the strategy.

Authored *The AI Growth Code: Lessons from 126 Companies Winning with AI*, codifying the frameworks and playbooks that move organizations beyond AI experimentation into sustained, governed enterprise value.

14 years of digital transformation, including four years of hands-on architectural fluency across Generative AI, agentic architectures, custom GPTs, RAG pipelines, and Copilot/LLM ecosystems.

EXPERIENCE

THE AI PROS

August 2021 – Present

Director, AI Transformation | AI Strategy, Enablement & Automation | Remote-Nationwide

- Directed cross-functional delivery teams, including subcontractors and embedded staff, securing executive sponsorship and building enterprise AI roadmaps that drove **8% revenue growth** and **13% cost reduction** across **5-7** concurrent initiatives.
- Built and deployed an AI-powered sales proposal generation workflow for a large commercial HVAC organization, reducing proposal turnaround time by **94%**, from **90** minutes down to under **5**.
- Selected, implemented, and drove adoption of an AI/ML fraud detection platform for a financial services organization, cutting fraud losses **75%** and false positives from **35%** to **8%**, saving **\$240,000** annually.
- Upskilled **500+** stakeholders through custom AI enablement programs and change-management delivery, pairing prompt engineering, custom GPTs, and workflow automation with champion networks and user adoption metrics.
- Built an integrated **AI operating model** through hands-on execution, configuring agents and automations across **Make.com**, **Power Automate**, **Zapier**, **n8n**, and custom **Claude** skills that carry business intelligence enterprise-wide, from daily operations to executive decision-making, reducing operational costs by **30%** across partner organizations.
- Led C-suite envisioning sessions and discovery workshops, evaluating **5-8** use cases and vendor tradeoffs per initiative, building **14** reusable AI transformation accelerators.
- Created the **CREATE-Q** prompt formula, improving one-shot prompting accuracy by **85%** to enhance AI-assisted development workflows.
- Speaker at **7** industry conferences, presenting *The AI Growth Code* framework to **2,500+** attendees.

RICHARD RICE

AI STRATEGY & TRANSFORMATION
LEADER

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Advisory

AI Transformation Strategy & Road Mapping, Business Case Development, Capability Mapping, Cross-functional Steering, Build vs. Buy Decision-Making, Digital Transformation

Build & Architecture

Hands-On Agent & Automation Building, Agentic AI & RAG Architecture, Custom GPT Development, Process Automation & Workflow Optimization, Data Readiness Assessment, Generative AI Strategy

Adoption & Enablement

Enterprise AI Adoption & Enablement, Change Management Frameworks (Kotter's 8-Step, Lewin's Change Model, FASTER), AI Literacy Training, Upskilling Frameworks, Change Acceleration

Governance & Value

AI Governance & Responsible AI, Data Governance, Regulatory Compliance (NIST AI RMF), Risk Mitigation, Value Realization & ROI Quantification, AI Adoption Metrics / KPI Tracking

EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

SECUREIT TACTICAL

October 2020 – July 2021

Vice President, Sales & Marketing | Firearm Storage E-commerce | Remote-Nationwide

- Grew eCommerce sales **12% YoY** by directing a **6-person** team, external marketing agency partners and **30+** industry influencers across major social platforms, enhancing digital marketing and data-driven strategy.

NORTH AMERICAN RESCUE

March 2019 – October 2020

Vice President, Marketing | Medical & Tactical Gear E-commerce | Greenville, SC

- Drove digital transformation, repositioning the company from B2B to B2C, increasing website eCommerce sales by **45% YoY**.
- Built and led a **5-person** marketing team and directed external agency partners to forge an owned-audience marketing initiative capturing **92,000+** prospects and customers.
- Launched NARMD, an online ordering platform that cut internal order processing time **60%** for government customers.

MOBILE MINI (NASDAQ: MINI)

February 2017 – February 2019

Senior Manager, Digital Sales & Marketing | Portable Storage | Phoenix, AZ

- Integrated sales goals with a **\$1.4M** annual digital marketing budget and external agency partners, generating **66,000** leads and cutting cost per lead **48% YoY**.
- Reimagined sales compensation structure for an **8-person** digital sales team, increasing performance by **45%**.
- Doubled closing rates with a Salesforce-integrated automated dialer that cut speed-to-lead to **5 minutes**, and grew exclusive branded leads **+200%** through a full overhaul of the lead mix.
- Won the 2018 Acquia Engage Award for Website-Best Return on Investment.

HEARST DIGITAL MEDIA

February 2015 – July 2016

Regional Sales Director | Digital Media/Publishing | Southwest Texas Territory

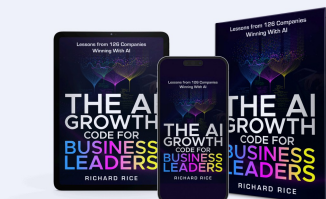
- Ranked **#1** in team performance and earned President's Club recognition in 2015, increasing top-line revenue by **\$800K**.
- Led 3 sales managers overseeing **20-25** reps, championing digital solutions and mentoring teams to drive **58%** growth in digital channel sales.

DEX MEDIA

June 2012 – February 2015

District Sales Manager | Digital Media/Publishing | Albuquerque/Santa Fe, NM

- Ranked **#1** in team performance and earned President's Club recognition in 2013, leading an **8-rep** sales team.



PUBLISHED AUTHOR

The AI Growth Code: Lessons from 126 Companies Winning with AI